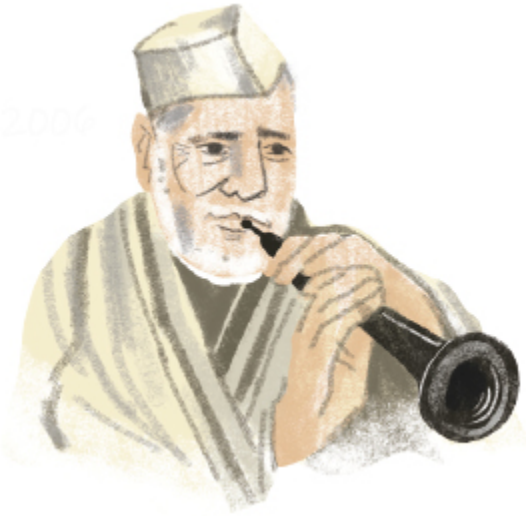


BISMILLAH KHAN

1916–2006



Khan was such a popular and well-respected figure that he was chosen to perform at two of modern India’s most significant moments: India’s first Independence Day in 1947 and its first Republic Day in 1950. His music became an indelible part of Independence Day celebrations for many years—a live performance was telecast immediately after the prime minister’s speech.